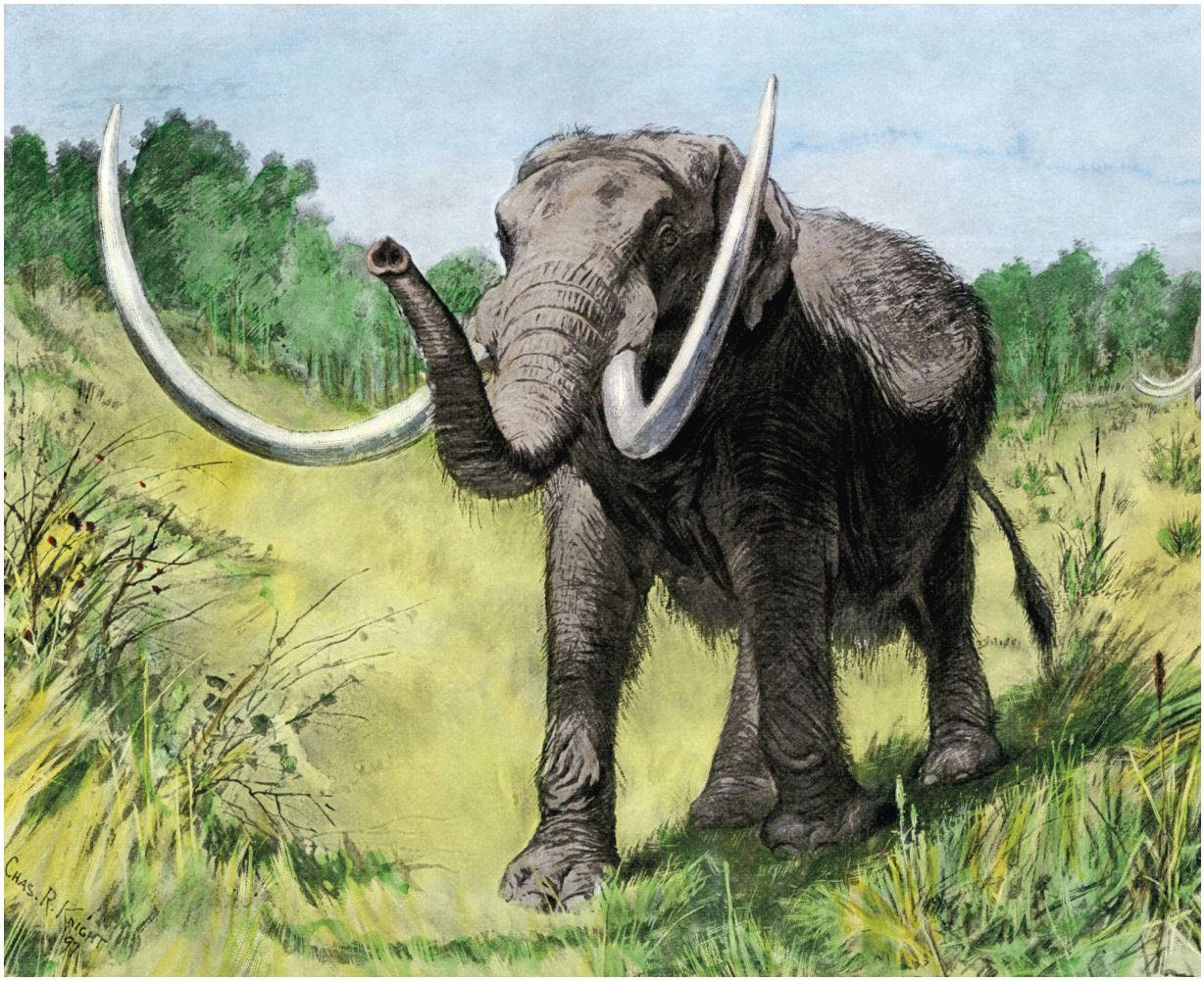


Cuvier coined the name “mastodon” for its Greek meaning of “breast tooth,” referring to the nipplelike patterns on the creature’s teeth, which were unlike those of any living elephants.

See also: Evolution by natural selection • Ecological niches • An ancient ice age • Mass extinctions